

UI/UX Analysis for Users Aged 55 Above

1. Chess.com

Positive UI/UX Features for Older Adults (55 above)

Large chessboard and pieces

The board is clear and visually easy to follow, especially in default themes.

Simple game structure

Chess rules are familiar to many older adults, reducing learning difficulty.

Customisable board themes

Users can change colours, board styles and piece designs for better visibility.

Move highlighting

Highlighted legal moves and last-move indicators help reduce confusion.

Adjustable game speed

Players can choose slower time controls or untimed games, reducing stress.

Clean layout during matches

The main gameplay screen focuses mostly on the board without excessive distractions.

Puzzle and learning modes

Tutorials and guided lessons support cognitive engagement and lifelong learning.

Accessible on multiple devices

Works on tablets, laptops and phones, allowing flexible use.

UI/UX Challenges for Older Adults

Too many features on homepage

News, ads, clubs, videos and tournaments may overwhelm less confident users.

Small menu text in some areas

Navigation items and settings can feel crowded on smaller screens.

Fast animations and timers

Blitz or rapid modes may create pressure and anxiety for some older players.

Heavy use of notifications

Pop-ups and alerts may distract users from the main task.

Requires digital confidence

Some older adults unfamiliar with online gaming systems may need support initially.

Accessibility and Inclusive Design

Adjustable board contrast

Colourblind-friendly themes

Zoom support through browsers/tablets

Audio move feedback available

Simple drag-and-drop interactions

2. Microsoft Spider Solitaire

Positive UI/UX Features for Older Adults (55+)

Very familiar gameplay

Solitaire games are widely recognised by older generations.

Simple and uncluttered interface

Focus stays mainly on the cards and controls.

Large cards and symbols

Card suits and numbers are generally easy to identify.

Relaxing pace

No pressure to act quickly, making gameplay comfortable.

Clear visual hierarchy

Important controls such as undo, hints and restart are easy to locate.

Predictable interactions

Dragging and stacking cards feels intuitive.

Calming experience

The game encourages relaxation and concentration rather than competition.

Helpful hint system

Hints reduce frustration and support users who may struggle with strategy.

UI/UX Challenges for Older Adults

Advertisements in some versions

Ads can interrupt concentration and confuse users.

Small buttons on mobile devices

Touch interactions may become difficult for users with reduced dexterity.

Limited accessibility settings

Fewer visual customisation options compared to modern accessibility standards.

Repeated gameplay may feel monotonous

Some users may lose engagement over time.

Accessibility and Inclusive Design

Simple click-and-drag controls

Clear card contrast

Minimal text requirements

Slow-paced gameplay

Undo feature reduces stress and mistakes